

Book II - The Spiral and the Block

Part 1 - The True Republic

Chapter 07 - Do Laws Create Morality

EP04 — Do Laws Create Morality?

Series: True Republic **Type:** Street / Campus Interview **Core Question:** "Is something wrong because it's illegal, or illegal because it's wrong?"

The Seed Being Planted

Law and morality are often conflated. But they diverge constantly throughout history — slavery was legal, harboring Jews in Nazi Germany was illegal.

The Sagent Creed describes "a law written on the human heart that no legislature can repeal and no tyrant can revise." This episode asks people to find that law in themselves — and notice that it existed before any government told them about it.

Interview Arc

Opening Question

"Is something wrong because it's illegal — or illegal because it's wrong?"

Follow-Up Questions

- "Can you think of something that was legal that was clearly wrong?"
- "Can you think of something illegal that seems morally fine?"
- "Where does your sense of right and wrong come from — law, or something else?"
- "If a law required you to do something you knew was wrong, would you do it?"
- "Does a vote make something moral?"

- "If 51% of people vote to enslave the other 49%, is it moral?"

The Contradiction That Often Emerges

People will affirm that morality is separate from law — then struggle to explain why they should obey laws they believe are unjust. The discovery: their conscience was always prior to the law. The law never created it.

Cold Open Script (Narrator)

"At the Nuremberg trials, soldiers said they were just following orders. The court said that wasn't good enough. Which means — the court was saying there is a law above the law. Where does that law come from?"

Closing Narration

The Sagent Creed calls this "the still, deep source every human being carries encoded in their conscience." Governments don't create moral law — they either reflect it or violate it. When people discover that their conscience preceded every legal code, they've found something the jar-shaker cannot shake.

Source Quotes

Direct quotes from Sage's own writing to draw from when scripting this episode.

"The true obligation of each person is to do what is right, not what is legal. What is right never changes but it is discovered over time. Man cannot change right and wrong just as man cannot change gravity."

"The legislation is with everyone. It is not what happens in some Roman-style building that created laws — God created law and wrote it on our hearts and the discussion is to help access what we already know underneath all the dogma."

"If the command of men contradicts the command of God, follow God. If the command of men aligns with the command of God, follow God still. Right action is not determined by human decree but by eternal truth."

"When good men are convinced that good soldiers follow orders no matter what, they are no longer good protectors but weapons of destruction."

"What is the difference between humans and animals? A conscience. The intuition to know what is right and wrong. Animals just act without a concept of right and wrong."

"It is every person's duty to do what is right not what is legal. That is what makes humanity different from machines."

The Living Age Trilogy